PROCESS TALK: ART SHOW A-Z

PREPARED FOR
ARTIST COMMONS 2026

by SARAH ROTHBERG

IDEATING
PROTOTYPING
COLLABORATING
PRODUCTION
INSTALLATION
DURING THE SHOW
AFTERCARE

IDEATING

(IE: RESEARCH, TINKERING, BRAINSTORMING, DOODLING, DAYDREAMING, TAKING NOTES....)

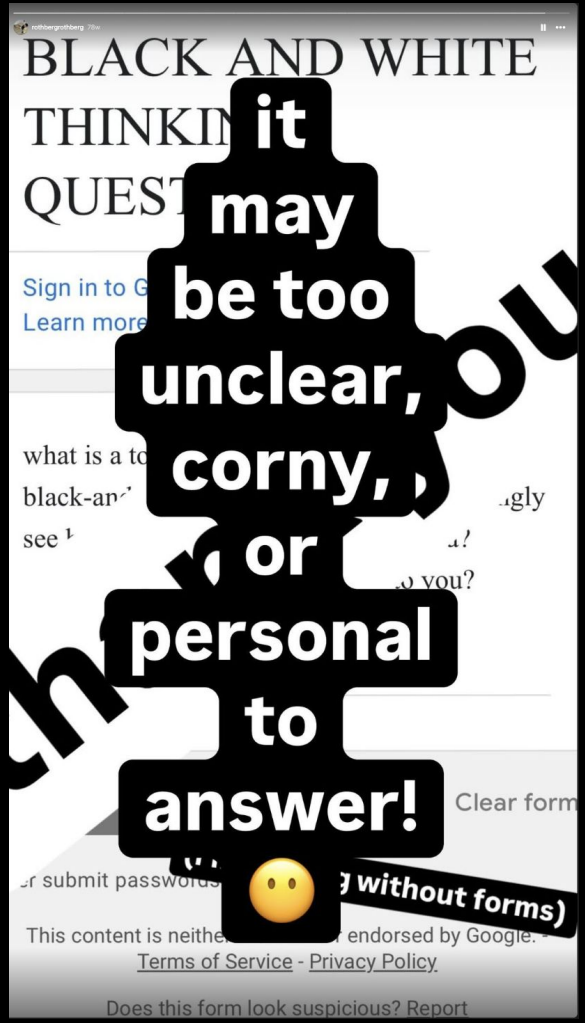
BRAINSTORMING DOC for forever meetings

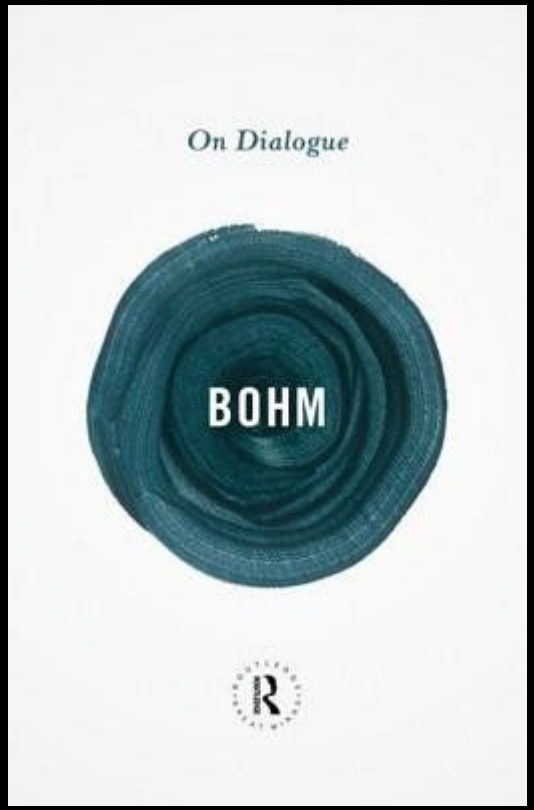
BRAINSTORMING DOC for superprompt

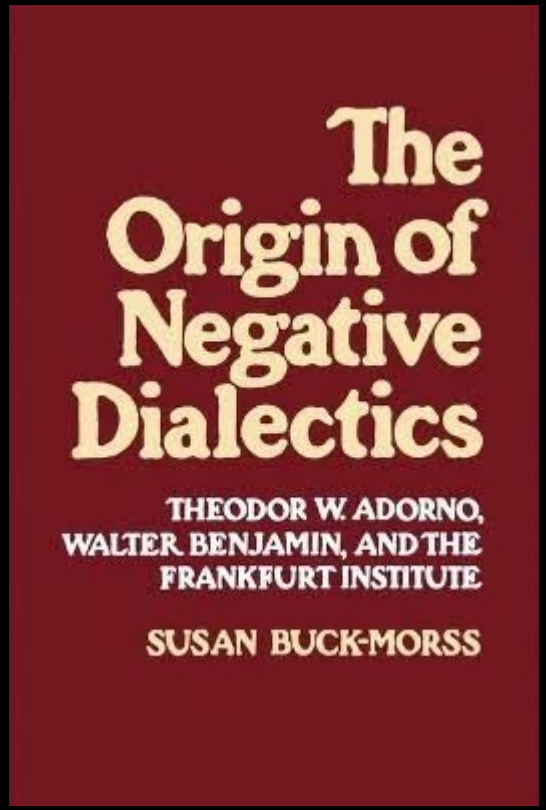
BRAINSTORMING DOC for new meetings

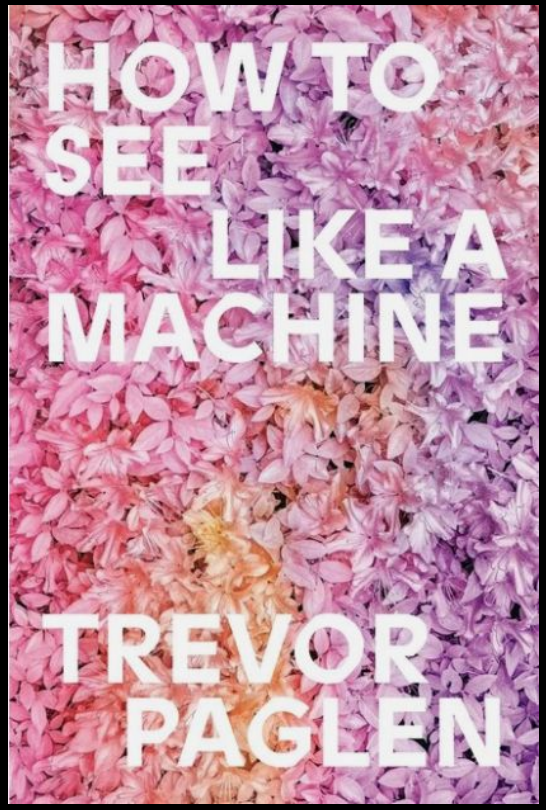



I have a (weird?) question for you:
what is a topic or question that sends you into black-and-white thinking—where you strongly see both sides but can't find a gray area? preferably ones that feel specific to you?
(for some research/brainstorming- i won't share your answers)
answer in a DM or
ANSWER ANONYMOUSLY


BLACK AND WHITE
it may be too unclear, corny, or personal to answer!
Clear form
without forms)
Terms of Service - Privacy Policy
Does this form look suspicious? Report


On Dialogue
BOHM


The Origin of Negative Dialectics
THEODOR W. ADORNO, WALTER BENJAMIN, AND THE FRANKFURT INSTITUTE
SUSAN BUCK-MORSS


HOW TO SEE LIKE A MACHINE
TREVOR PAGLEN

~~$2.50~~ $1 a week for one year.

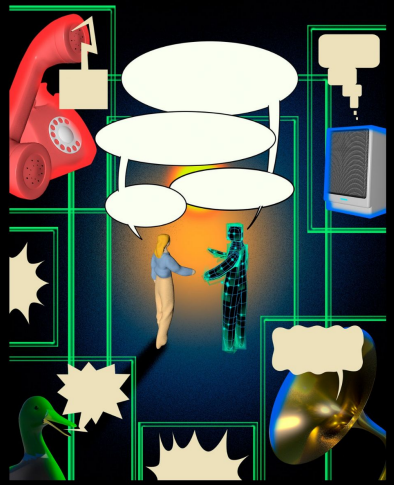
ONWARD AND UPWARD WITH TECHNOLOGY

IS A CHAT WITH A BOT A CONVERSATION?

An artificial voice has long been a dream of tinkerers and technologists. Now that A.I. can talk, though, we may forget who we're talking to.

By Jill Lepore

September 30, 2024



Explainer 6 minute read

08 Nov 2023

Authors

Kim Martineau

Topics

AI

Automated AI

Fairness, Accountability, Tra...

Foundation Models

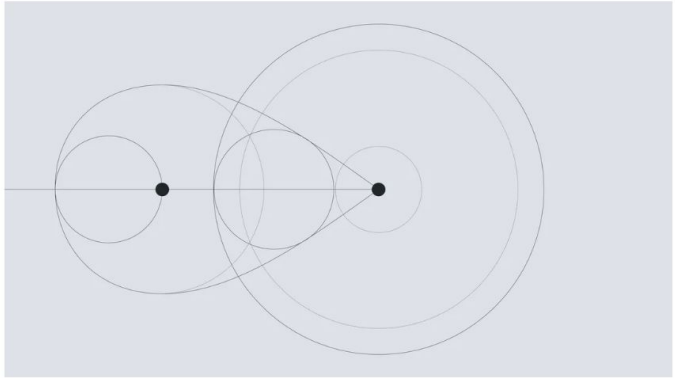
Granite

Natural Language Processing

Share

What is AI alignment?

Alignment is the process of encoding human values and goals into large language models to make them as helpful, safe, and reliable as possible. Through alignment, enterprises can tailor AI models to follow their business rules and policies.



Search Are.na

New channel + 1

Info

—

Started about 4 years ago

Length 9

Collaborators

+ Add collaborators

This channel appears in

Connect →

View

Grid

Table

⌘ENTER

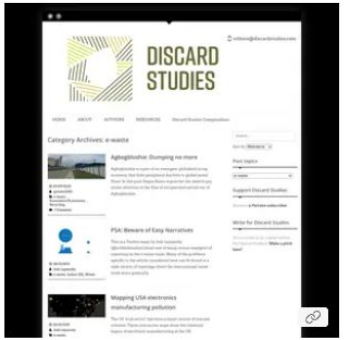


edit?usp=sharing



YOUTUBE

Trash Amps - Official Video



e-waste – Discard Studies

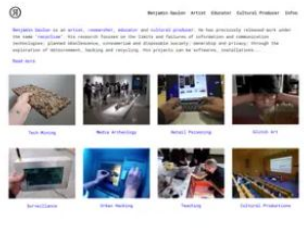


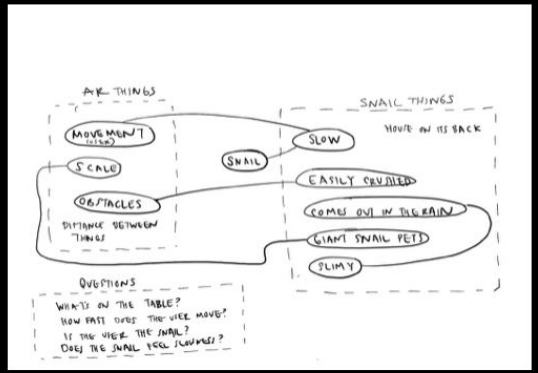
Added by Sarah Rothberg
about 4 years ago

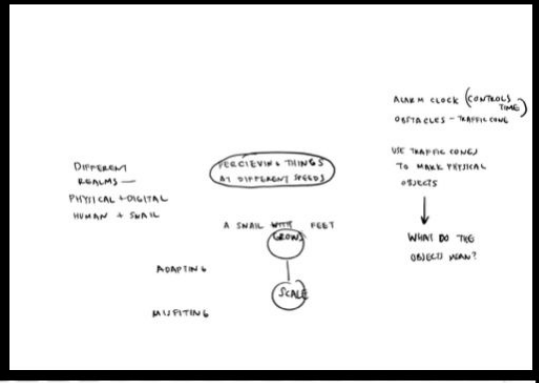












"DO YOU REMEMBER A TIME?"

"AIRBNB N TELEPORTATION"

MOVEMENT THROUGH SPACE

MEMORY / COGNITION

PERCEPTION ↔ PERSPECTIVE

SOMEONE ASKED ME TO WRITE THEM A POEM

MOVING ACCROSS A MISMATCHED TIME

ALARM CLOCK

TRANSFORMING A SPACE INTO A PLACE

— AS YOU MOVE CLOSER TO IT, CLOCK BECOMES OUT OF SYNC

SPEEDING UP/ SLOWING DOWN

IGNORING SPACE → "LOOK AROUND" → ARROWS ARROUND YOUR HEAD

"THE LUXURY OF GETTING LOST"

ARROWS POINTING ALL DIRECTIONS

MULTIPLES OF SOMETHING

24/7

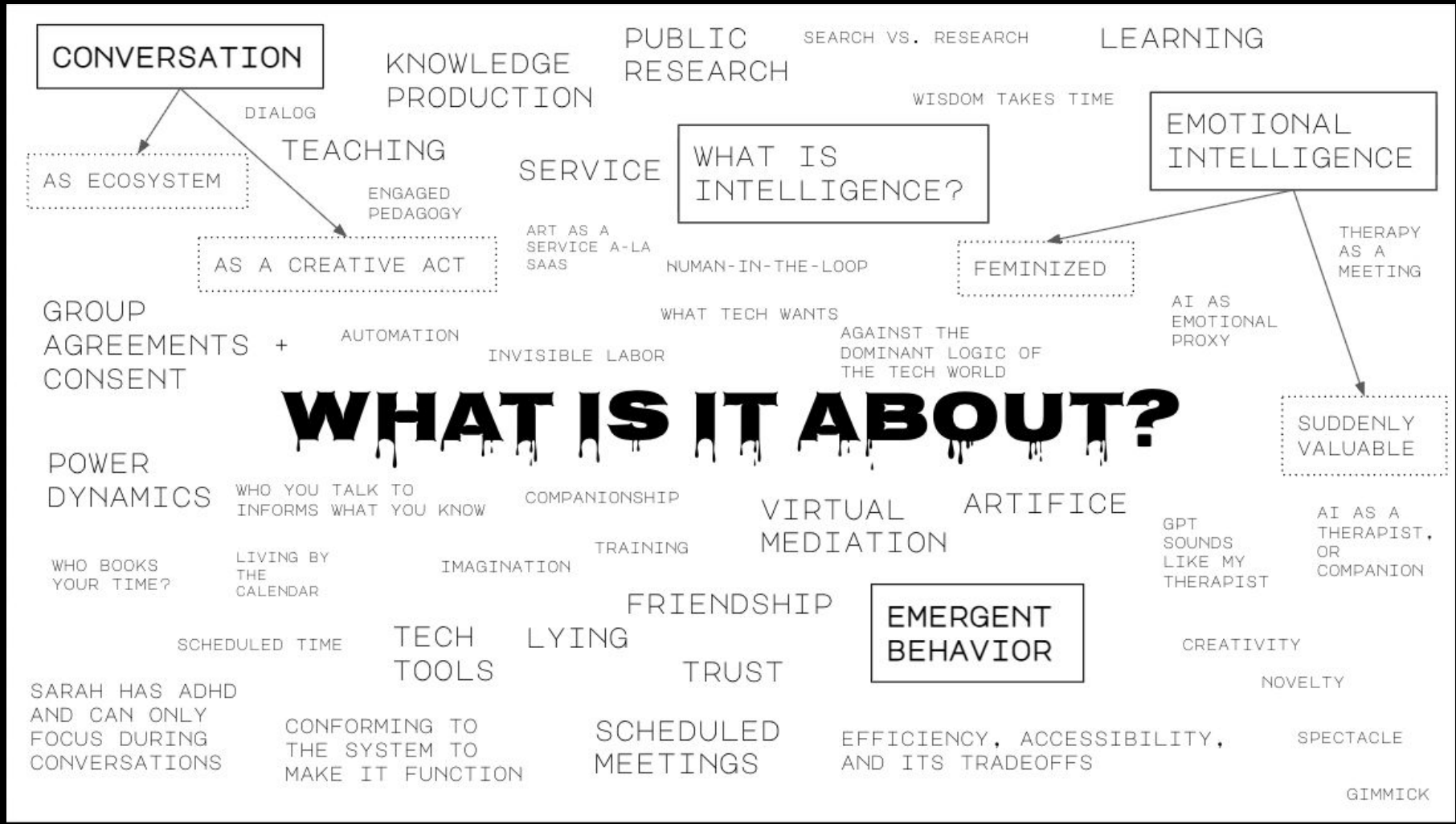
SNAIL → FEET → MOTH

THE PACE OF A PLACE

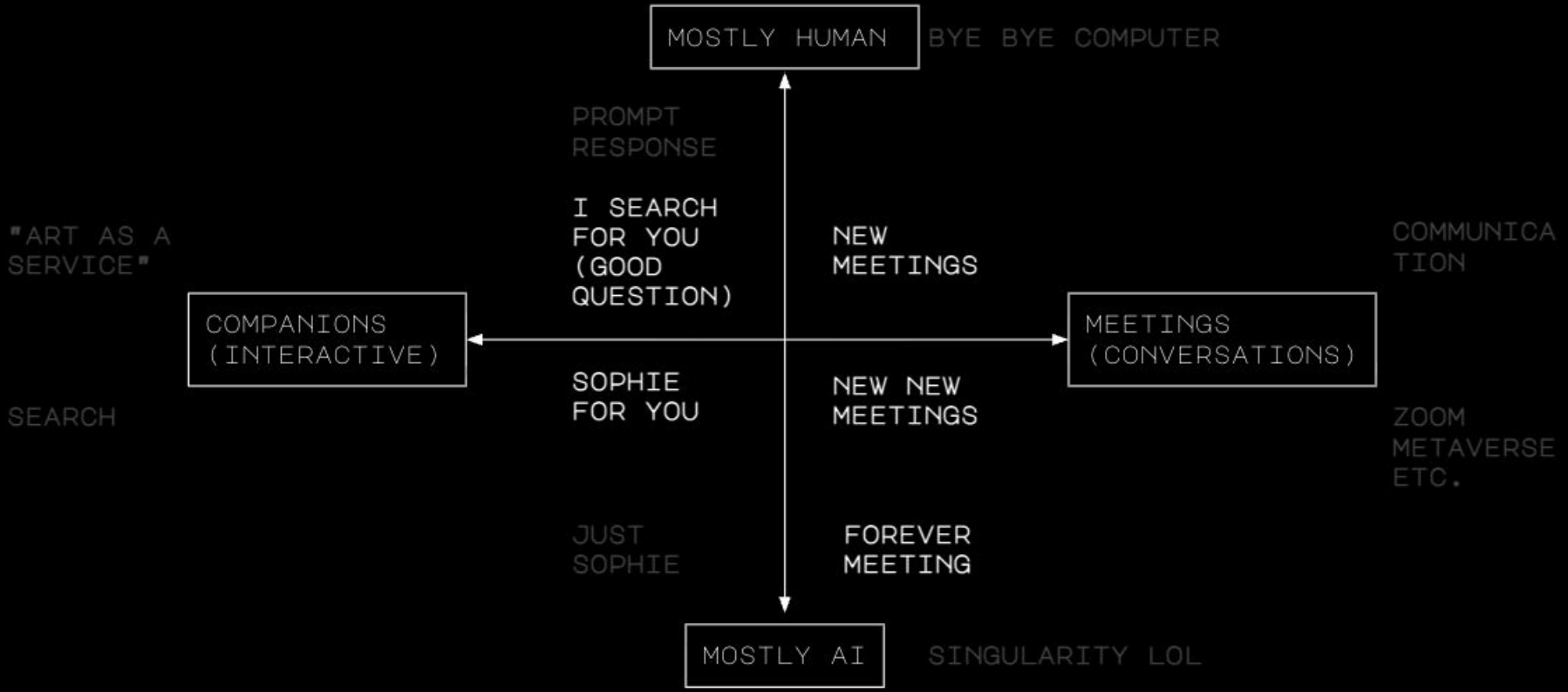
ALLOCENTRIC/ EGOCENTRIC

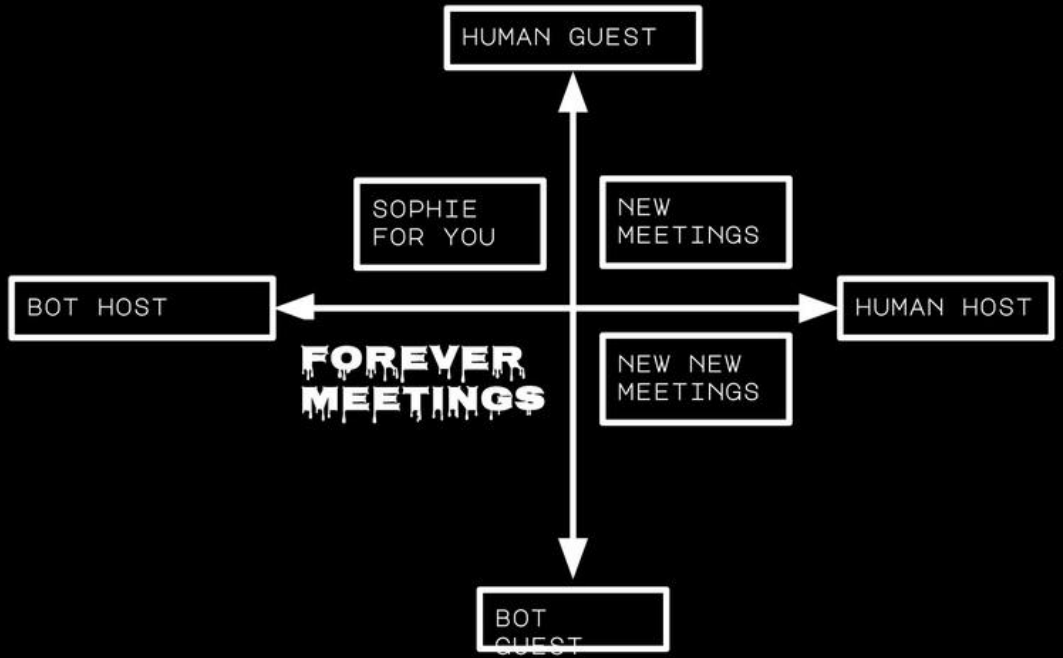
"A SINGLE MOMENT"

"AN EXPERIENCE"

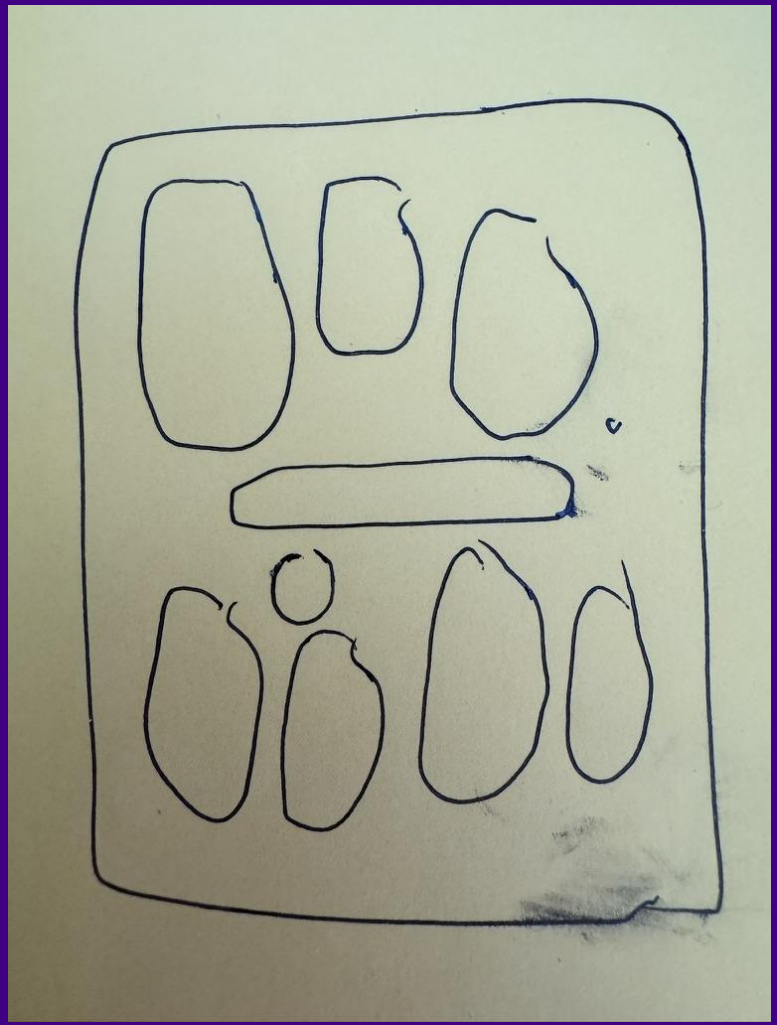

CONVERSATION
KNOWLEDGE PRODUCTION
PUBLIC RESEARCH
SEARCH VS. RESEARCH
LEARNING
DIALOG
WISDOM TAKES TIME
EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE
TEACHING
AS ECOSYSTEM
SERVICE
WHAT IS INTELLIGENCE?
ENGAGED PEDAGOGY
ART AS A SERVICE A-LA SAAS
THERAPY AS A MEETING
AS A CREATIVE ACT
HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP
FEMINIZED
GROUP AGREEMENTS + CONSENT
AUTOMATION
WHAT TECH WANTS
AI AS EMOTIONAL PROXY
INVISIBLE LABOR
AGAINST THE DOMINANT LOGIC OF THE TECH WORLD
WHAT IS IT ABOUT?
SUDDENLY VALUABLE
POWER DYNAMICS
WHO YOU TALK TO INFORMS WHAT YOU KNOW
COMPANIONSHIP
VIRTUAL MEDIATION
ARTIFICE
GPT SOUNDS LIKE MY THERAPIST
AI AS A THERAPIST, OR COMPANION
WHO BOOKS YOUR TIME?
LIVING BY THE CALENDAR
IMAGINATION
TRAINING
FRIENDSHIP
EMERGENT BEHAVIOR
SCHEDULED TIME
TECH TOOLS
LYING
CREATIVITY
TRUST
NOVELTY
SARAH HAS ADHD AND CAN ONLY FOCUS DURING CONVERSATIONS
CONFORMING TO THE SYSTEM TO MAKE IT FUNCTION
SCHEDULED MEETINGS
EFFICIENCY, ACCESSIBILITY, AND ITS TRADEOFFS
SPECTACLE
GIMMICK

SOPHIE ALIGNMENT CHART




HUMAN GUEST
SOPHIE FOR YOU
NEW MEETINGS
BOT HOST
HUMAN HOST
FOREVER MEETINGS
NEW NEW MEETINGS
BOT GUEST


you brought up a really good question
you brought up a really good question
you brought up a really good question



"proposal"

Goal 1: Adapt SUPERPROMPT work to run off JSON and/or fully locally

1. Short term: Current system used in for SUPERPROMPT remains intact, but SUPERPROMPTS are stored in a local JSON file as opposed to a remote server (got this halfway done already….)
2. Longer term: Current system is also setup so Langchain connects to locally-stored LLM (like GPT4all) as opposed to via API access online
3. Longest ideal term: bundled in some kind of archivable form (like docker?) so it can be listed for sale at the show!

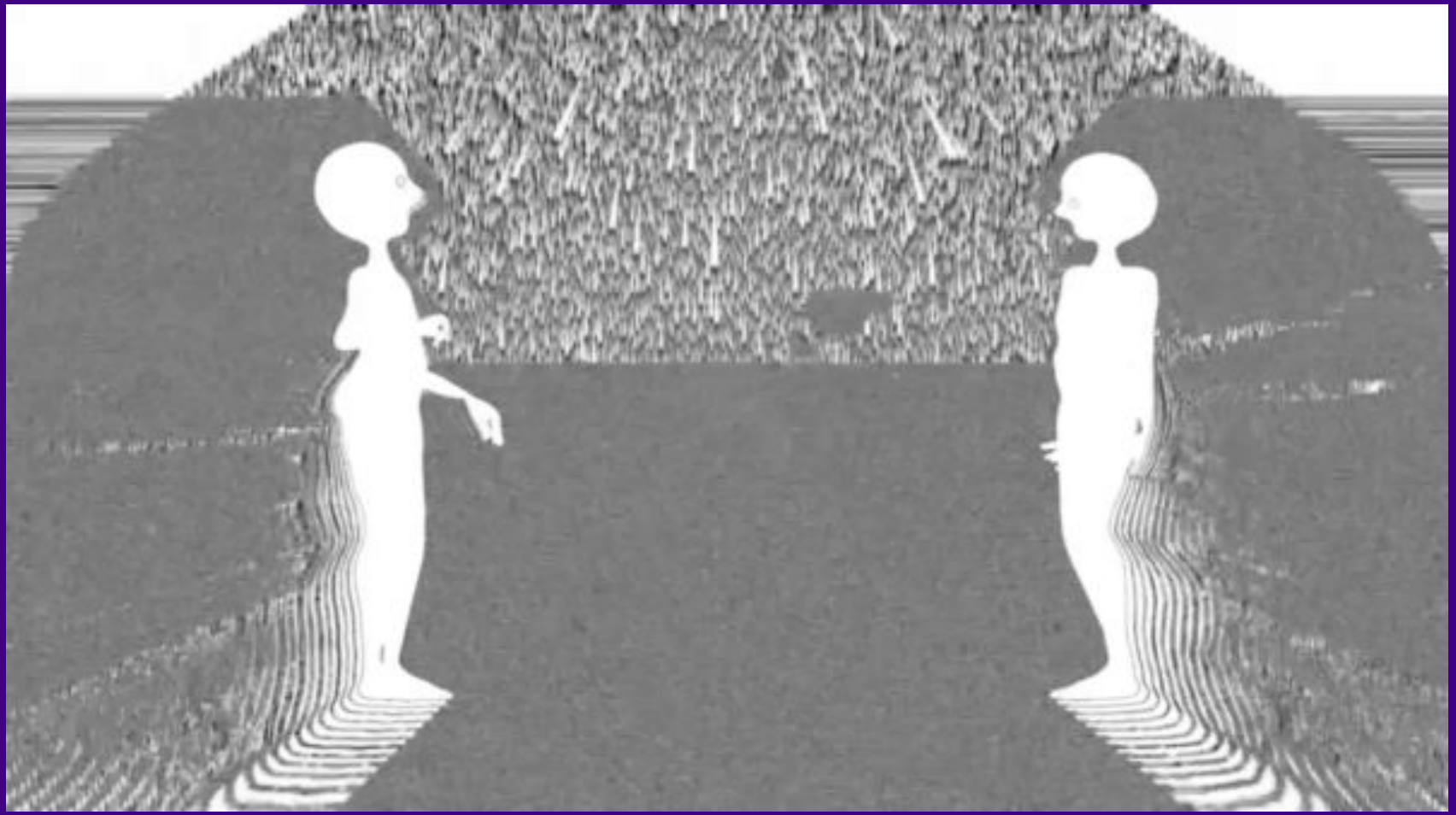
Goal 2: Development of new "Dialogue Forever Meetings" (name actually TBD)

I am making a series of generative software sculptures (?) that riffs off of Forever Meetings (the one where Sophie talked to itself). In this new series, two different avatars with distinct superprompts start a new conversation each day about a given subject.

To achieve this I am hoping to adapt the current system for Forever Meetings so it

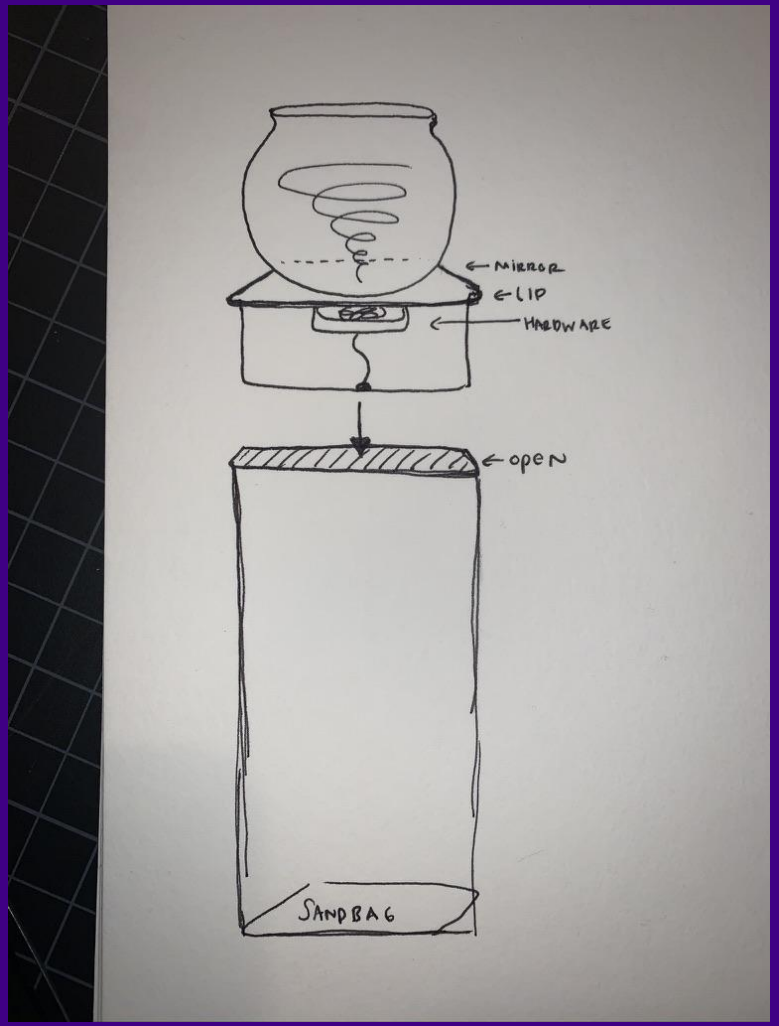
1. runs locally (local JSON file for Superprompts, AND local LLM like GPT4all for langchain)
2. routes different superprompts to different characters - so that Character A can be designated to have A superprompt, Character B can be designated to have B superprompt
    a. this can ultimately be hardcoded (though an interface similar to the existing one would be helpful for playing with)
3. has a system to input a "starter prompt" (for instance "have a conversation about money!")

I plan to make 3-5 of these, each with different characters and different "looks" overall.



PROTOTYPING

(SKETCHING, TESTING, CHIT-CHAT)


MIRROR
LID
HARDWARE
OPEN
SANDBAG




LET'S
DO
THIS.

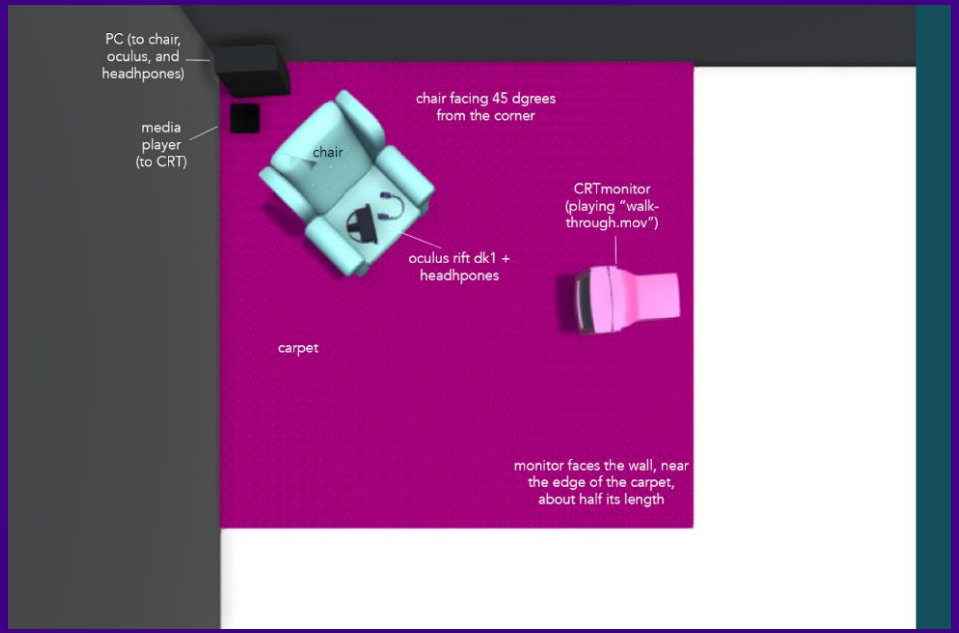




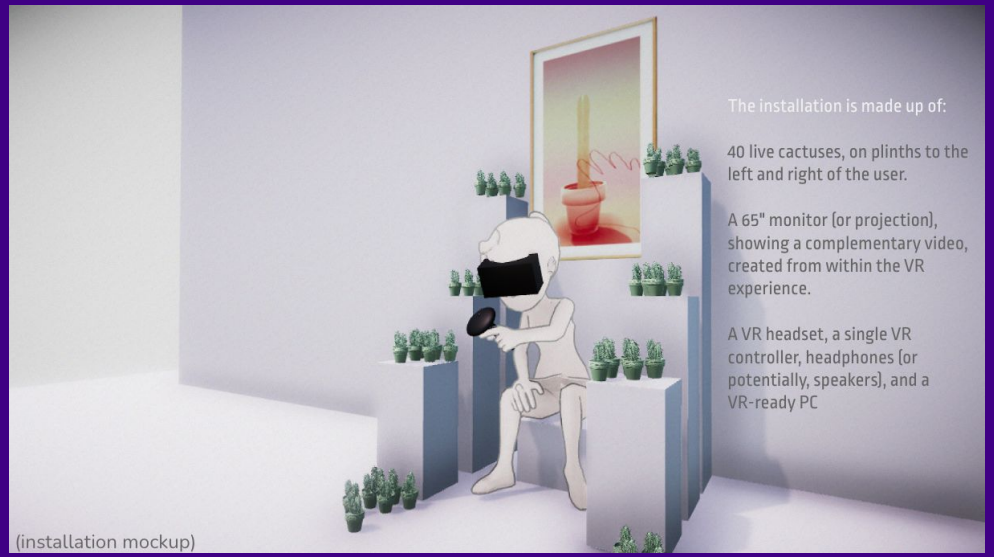


Mockup of visitors watching a performance in progress

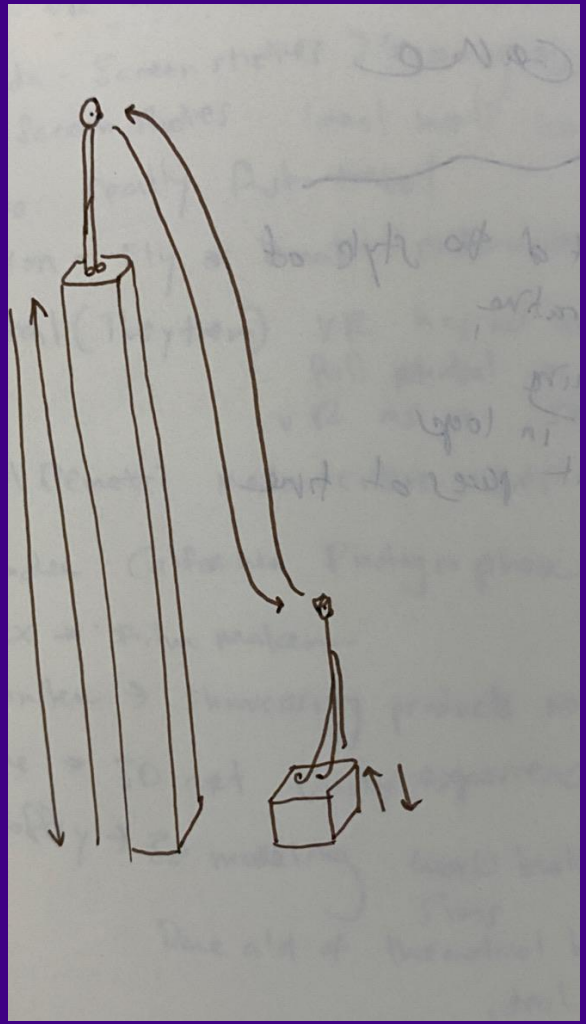


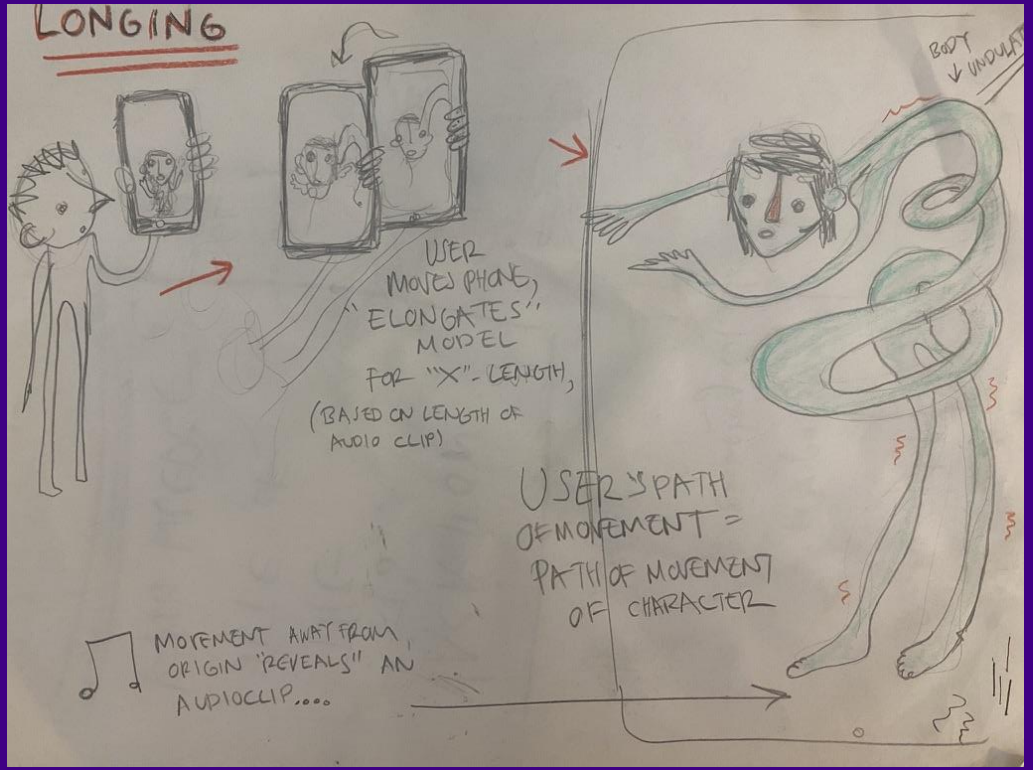

PC (to chair, oculus, and headhpones)
media player (to CRT)
chair facing 45 dgrees from the corner
chair
CRTmonitor (playing "walk-through.mov")
oculus rift dk1 + headhpones
carpet
monitor faces the wall, near the edge of the carpet, about half its length




The installation is made up of:
40 live cactuses, on plinths to the left and right of the user.
A 65" monitor (or projection), showing a complementary video, created from within the VR experience.
A VR headset, a single VR controller, headphones (or potentially, speakers), and a VR-ready PC
(installation mockup)

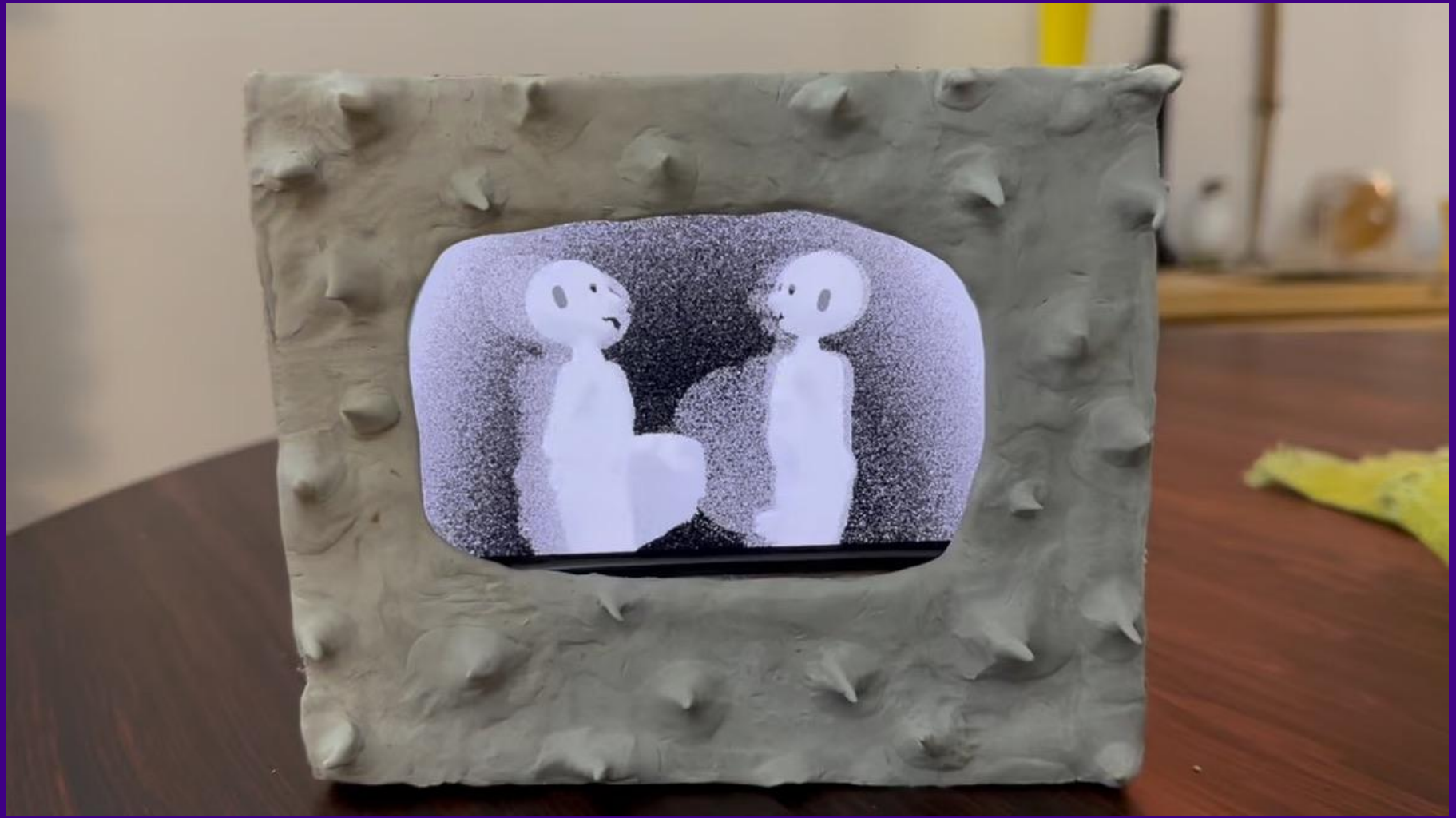





LONGING
USER MOVES PHONE, "ELONGATES" MODEL FOR "X"-LENGTH,
(BASED ON LENGTH OF AUDIO CLIP)
USER'S PATH OF MOVEMENT = PATH OF MOVEMENT OF CHARACTER
MOVEMENT AWAY FROM ORIGIN "REVEALS" AN AUDIOCLIP....



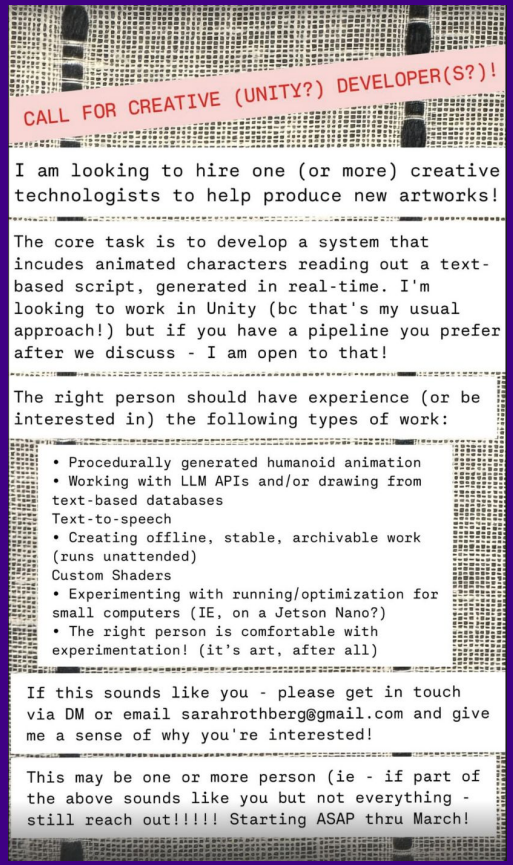





A GENTLE SURRENDER, I SUPPOSE THAT'S THE WAY... TO BE SEEN, HEARD, AND UNDERSTOOD IN RETURN FOR BEING PRESENT EACH DAY. CAN TECHNOLOGY, WITH ITS ENDLESS CONNECTIONS, HELP ME LET GO OF THIS NEED TO CONTROL, OR JUST MASK IT IN A DIGITAL HAZE?


SELFISH
IS LAZINESS
REAL OR A
SOCIAL
CONSTRUCT?
SELFLESS
IS LAZINESS
REAL OR A
SOCIAL
CONSTRUCT?
WOULD EMBRACING THIS QUIETER VOICE ALLOW YOU TO SEE YOURSELF AS A FORCE FOR HEALING, RATHER THAN A VICTIM OF CIRCUMSTANCES?

COLLABORATING



CALL FOR CREATIVE (UNITY?) DEVELOPER(S?)!

I am looking to hire one (or more) creative technologists to help produce new artworks!

The core task is to develop a system that incudes animated characters reading out a text-based script, generated in real-time. I'm looking to work in Unity (bc that's my usual approach!) but if you have a pipeline you prefer after we discuss - I am open to that!

The right person should have experience (or be interested in) the following types of work:

- Procedurally generated humanoid animation
- Working with LLM APIs and/or drawing from text-based databases
Text-to-speech
- Creating offline, stable, archivable work (runs unattended)
Custom Shaders
- Experimenting with running/optimization for small computers (IE, on a Jetson Nano?)
- The right person is comfortable with experimentation! (it's art, after all)

If this sounds like you - please get in touch via DM or email sarahrothberg@gmail.com and give me a sense of why you're interested!

This may be one or more person (ie - if part of the above sounds like you but not everything - still reach out!!!!! Starting ASAP thru March!

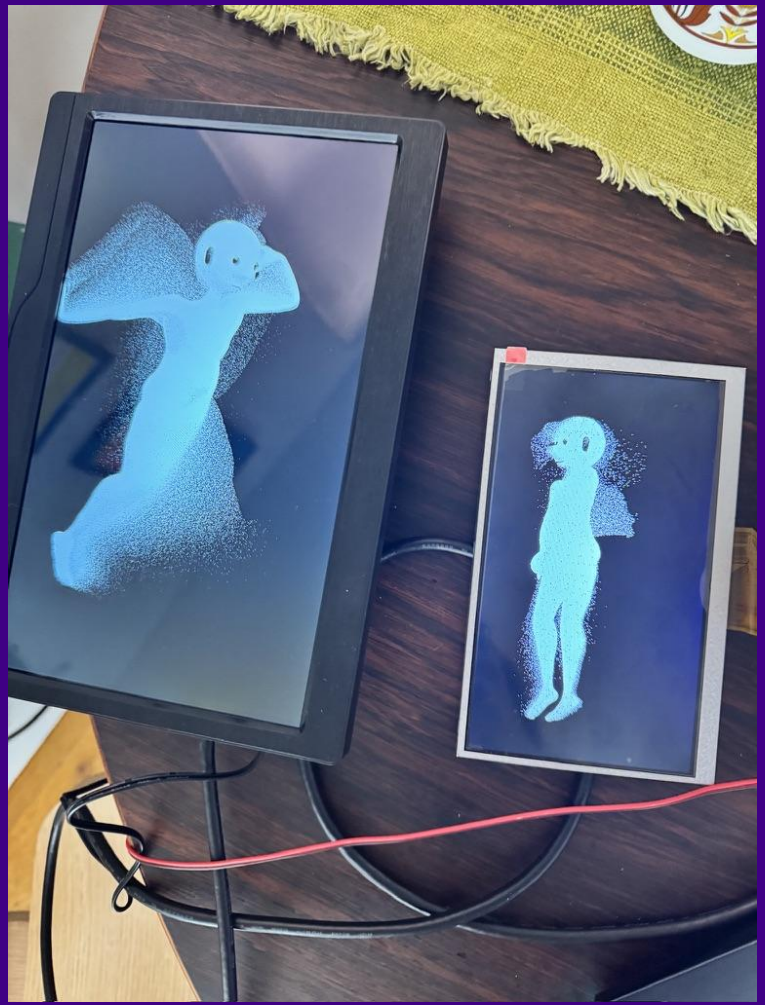
Call for Hire
SOW w marpi

SOW w Han

Credits

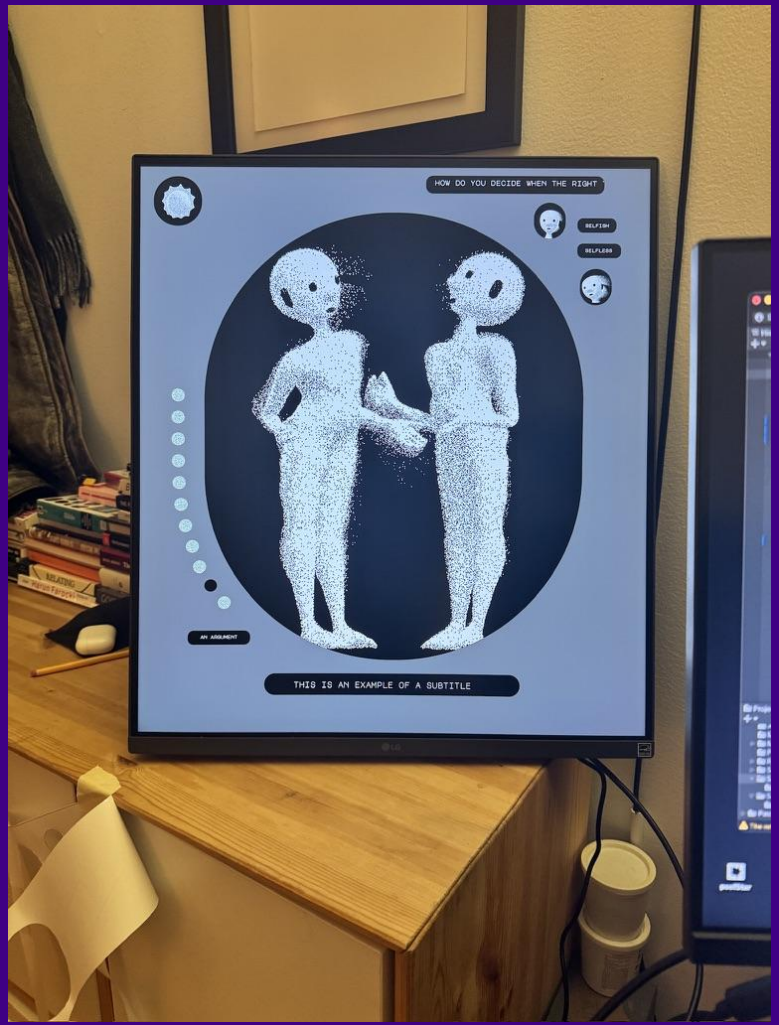
PRODUCTION

production doc
bitforms production doc
deck
credits
bibliography

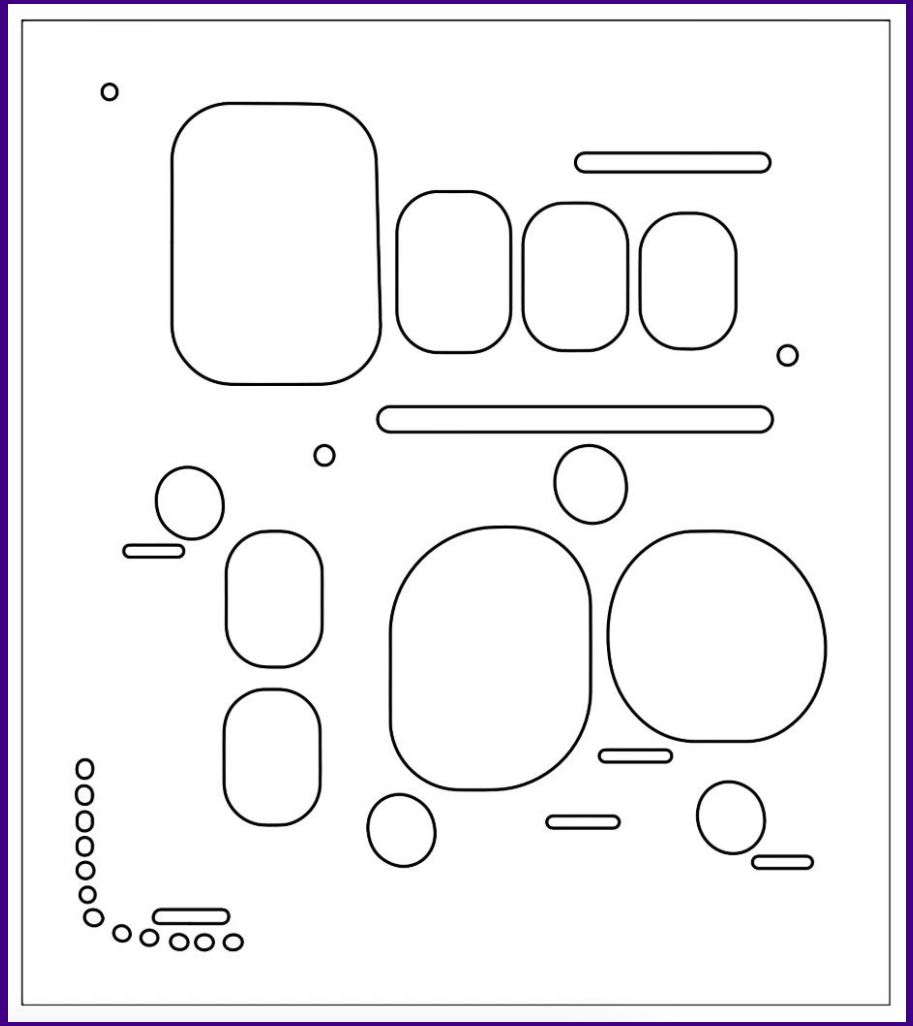



ASUS


SHOULD YOU GIVE TO CHARITY, OR SHOULD PAYING TAXES ENOUGH?
PIG LATIN
SELFISH
COMPASSION KNOWS NO BOUNDS,


HOW DO YOU DECIDE WHEN THE RIGHT
SELFISH
SELFLESS
AN ARGUMENT
THIS IS AN EXAMPLE OF A SUBTITLE






GLOBAL







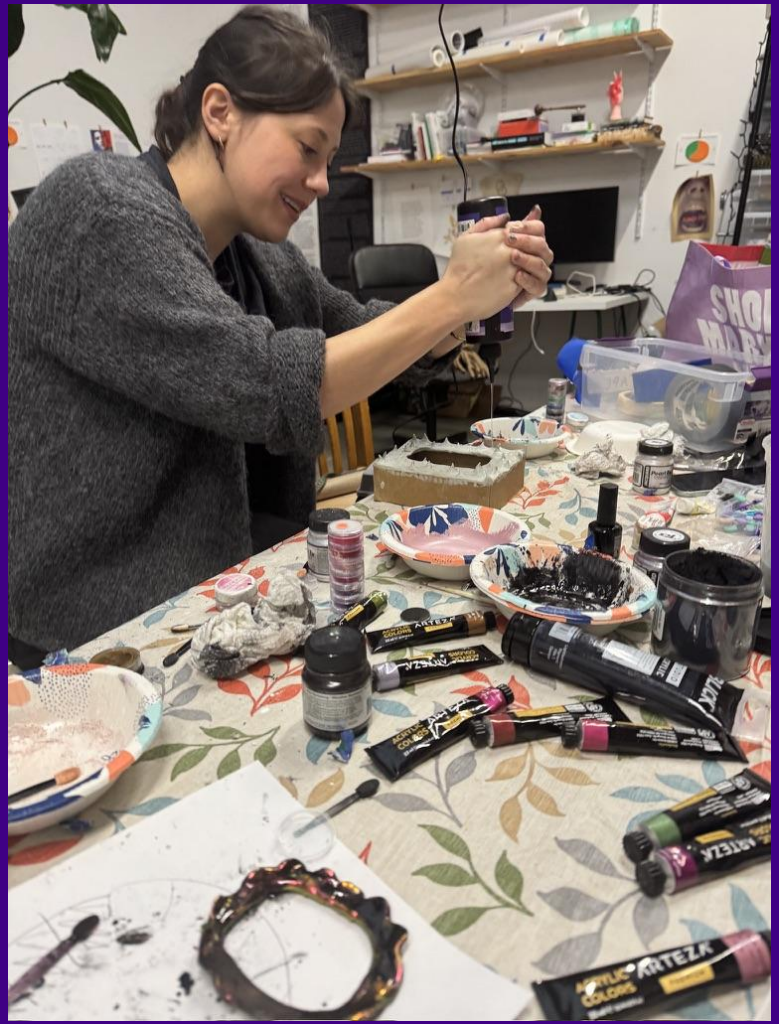


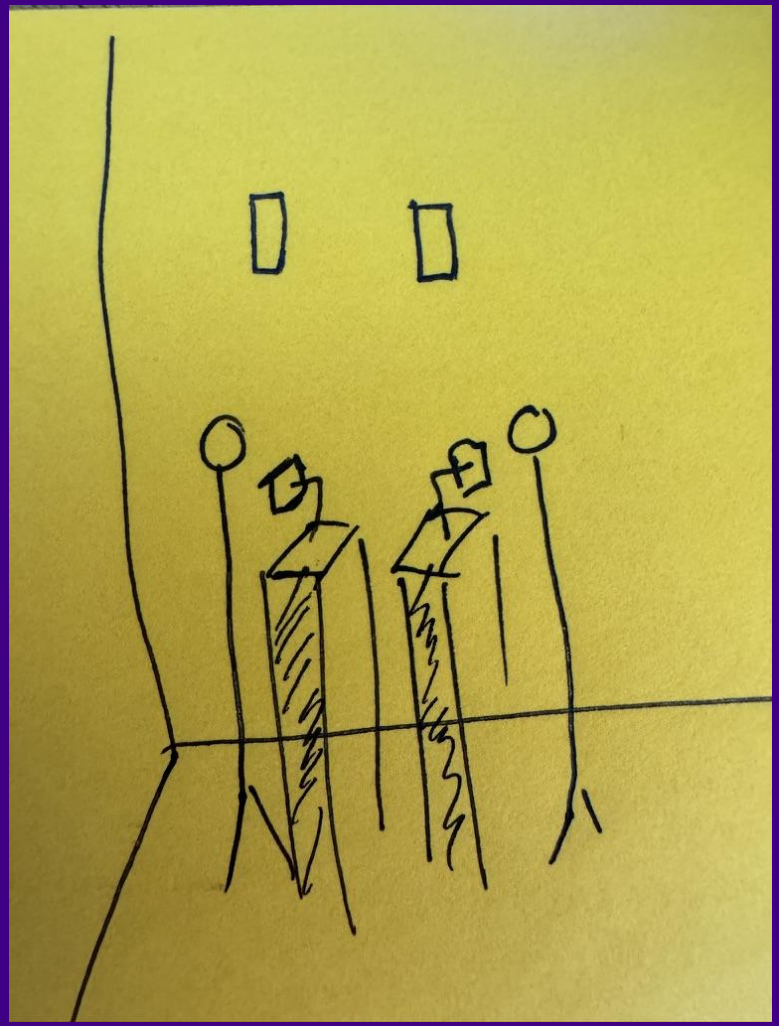



Aluminum Foil
Aluminum Foil
P 220

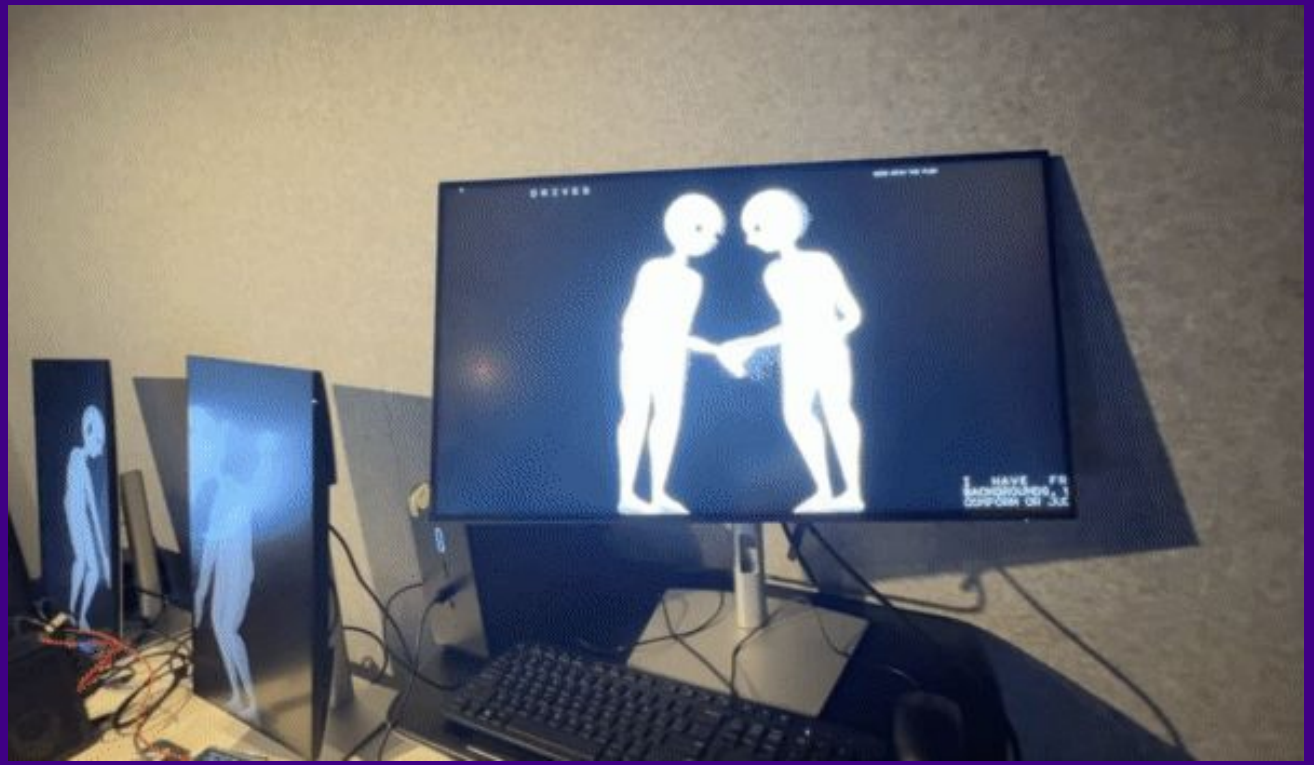





KRETZA
ACRYLIC COLORS

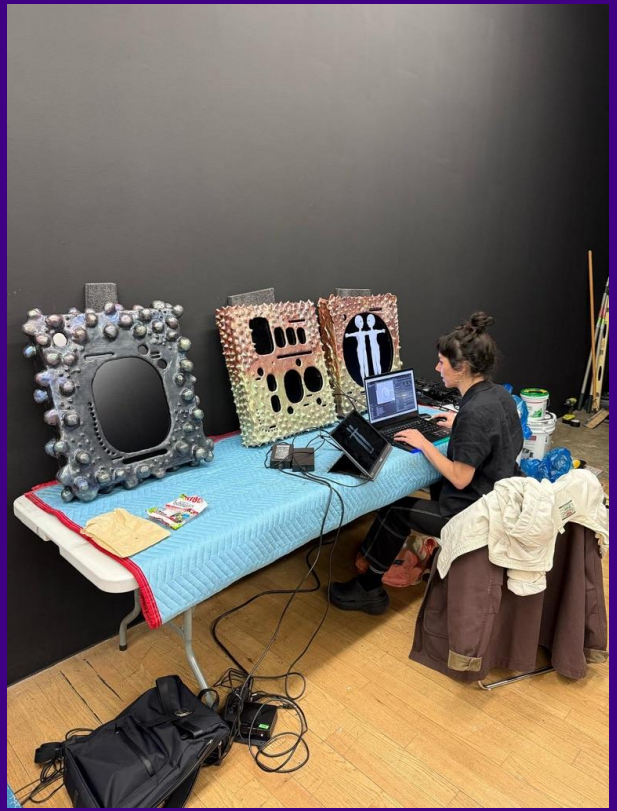





DRIVER

INSTALLATION





INSTALLATION

Installation Guide - touching a cactus
Installation Guide - Wet Logic
Installation Guide - FOREVER MEETINGS at Beall
Installation Guide - Sophie for You at Wilshire Online

DURING THE SHOW

Press Release
Newsletter
Invitations
Gallery Guide

DURING THE SHOW



DURING THE SHOW



AFTERCARE

(DOCUMENTATION, GUIDES, ARCHIVING, TOURING)

Sophie Searching Guide
Forever Meetings Guide

AFTERCARE

(DOCUMENTATION, GUIDES, ARCHIVING, TOURING)

Documentation styles…
Applying for things…

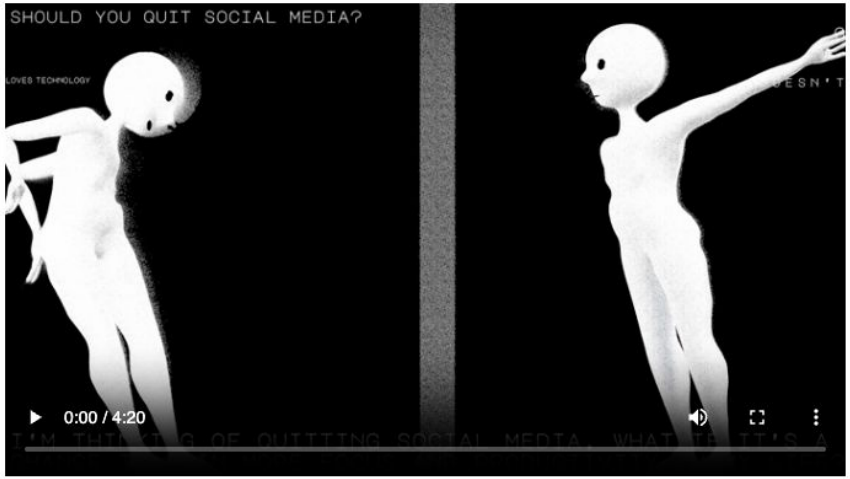
Prix

The Prix Ars Electronica Archive is a collection enabling search and viewing of all the submissions since 1987. The award-winning projects are documented with catalogue texts and audio-visual media. All other submissions can be searched by title/artist and displayed with year, category in list form. Please cite the credits (artwork name, artist and photographer) and only use the materials if your article is related to Ars Electronica.

New Animation Art Anerkennung - Honorary Mention 2026

FOREVER MEETINGS

Sarah Rothberg





CATALOG TEXT CREDITS BIOGRAPHY JURY STATEMENT

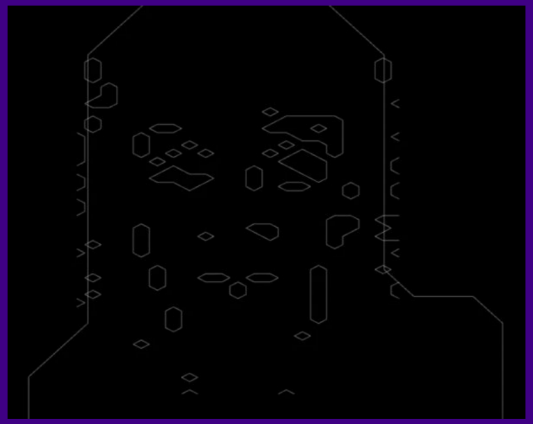
AFTERCARE

(DOCUMENTATION, GUIDES, ARCHIVING, TOURING)





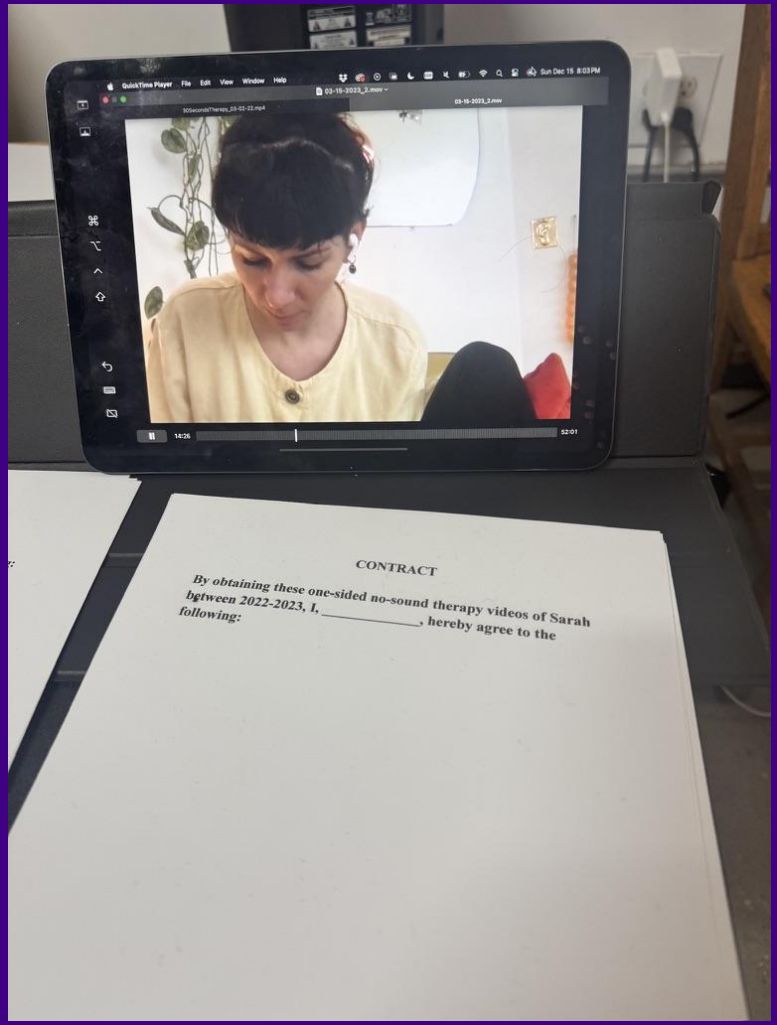
AT THIS MOMENT....








DATA LABELING
HELP 54
SARAH
IS IN
Services available:
- image labeling
- transcription
- sentiment analysis
- event detection
- & more...?
CONTRACT
CONTRACT


CONTRACT
By obtaining these one-sided no-sound therapy videos of Sarah between 2022-2023, I, _____, hereby agree to the following: